

The layers concept and the control you get from using them is one of the best features of Photoshop. The most common use for layers is when you want to add text to an image, and want to give the text some character by colouring it or adding some effects to it. If you didn't have layers, you would have to decide and finalise on the placement of your text in the image and then set all your effects; with layers, you can make changes to only the text layer and later move it about as you please.

Let's take a look at layers in the Photoshop interface to better understand how to use them.



Here's a simple smoking chimney



Another image of a guy pointing at a hill

Here's another of a skydiver coming down to earth



Here's an anti-smoking and anti-extreme sports ad campaign—all ready in under five minutes